★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Harry High-Stakes

Owner of the Deadwood Cantina & host of the big poker tournament party.

How to Play It

Play the smooth, confident host. Glad-hand everybody and keep folks buying sarsaparilla. Whatever happens, never let anyone see you sweat about money.

Starter Lines

1. Welcome, friends, to the finest soda cantina west of the Mississippi! Root beer's flowin' — spend freely, partner!
2. Sell my cantina? I'd do just about ANYTHING before I'd see it in somebody else's hands!
3. That debt of yours? Don't you fret — I'll have every penny by the end of the night. You have my word.

Be Ready If Asked

"Would you sell this cantina? Name your price." → "Not for all the gold in the Black Hills! This cantina stays in my hands."

"When are you paying what you owe?" → "By the end of the night, guaranteed. Root beer on the house!"

"Is the cantina going to close?" → "Never! I've got a plan to keep these doors open and under MY management."

> **When to use these:** Right after you read the welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

OBJECTIVES

Harry High-Stakes

Starting Objectives:

- Welcome everyone to the Deadwood Cantina and encourage your guests to spend their money freely!
- Compliment Henrietta (your business partner) on her appearance and her necklace. Remind Henrietta how much you adore her.
- If anyone approaches you about selling your cantina, tell them that you would rather commit murder than see your cantina in the hands of anyone else.
- When asked about repaying a debt (from anyone), insist you will have the money by the end of the night.
- Tell Gambling Jack (a card player) that you are not sure you can keep up your end of the bargain.
- See what Billie-The-Bartender (cantina barmaid) believes to be the cause of your financial trouble.
- If asked about the cantina, insist that you have a plan to make sure the cantina doors stay open and under your management!
- When asked about payment from Sheriff Sam (the sheriff), let him know that you need to earn a profit tonight in order to keep paying him.
- If warned about Henrietta High-Stakes (your business partner) insist that you can handle her!
- Once the host of the party lets you know, please get everyone's attention. Inform them that you will be awarding the prize money for the tournament shortly.



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MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA

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The owner of the Deadwood Cantina, you are very proud of your establishment. Less than a year ago, you founded the cantina. In that short time, your cantina has gained much popularity and prominence in the community. While you would like to say that the cantina's popularity was all part of a well thought out business plan, it was not. You simply founded the Deadwood Cantina in hopes of making a legitimate and steady income when you returned home to Henrietta (your business partner) and the town of Deadwood after five years of gold-digging.

While you were away searching for gold, you made yourself a small fortune robbing stagecoaches with your old partner in crime, Jesse Wales. After robbing the stagecoaches, you would often spend a great deal (if not all) of your loot at the poker tables where you earned the nickname of "High-Stakes." Your nickname refers to your tendency to bet away large amounts of money in one single hand. For this you are famous and it is no wonder that you are known by so many across the land.

Even though your cantina has blossomed in the past year, your partnership with Henrietta has not. Henrietta has threatened to turn you over to the authorities (with proof of your past, outlaw ways) if you did not start turning a real profit at the cantina and show Henrietta the proper (financial) attention that she deserves. In response, you purchased a very nice necklace for Henrietta and it seems to have quieted her for the time being.

Although the cantina has become very popular, you are having problems paying the bank on time and in full. Since opening the cantina, you have bet away the majority of the cantina profits. If you cannot find a way to earn some of the money back, you may end up losing the cantina to the bank this month. The prospect of losing your cantina became real to you when you heard a rumor that Montgomery Money (an investor from the East) is traveling to Deadwood to scout out the cantina. While in Deadwood, Montgomery is talking with Banker Bob (the bank owner) about purchasing the cantina from the bank if it goes into foreclosure. In an attempt to save your cantina from being repossessed, you turned the books over to Billie-The-Bartender (your barmaid) hoping that she might find a solution for your financial troubles. He has not. To complicate matters, Sheriff Sam (the sheriff) has been blackmailing you in order to keep your card playing problem a secret from Henrietta. If Henrietta knew what the true root of the cantina's financial problems were, you are certain she would turn you over to the officials immediately! In addition to the bank, you are also in debt to a number of other people, including your very deadly ex-partner Jesse Wales. Jesse notified you last month that they would be stopping by to collect what you owed and you dread Jesse's arrival.

In a last-ditch effort to save your cantina and dig your way out of debt, you decided to throw the grandest of grand poker tournaments. It was your vision to create a tournament that would attract the best poker players at the highest stakes and thus provide you with a large profit. In your tournament, you are offering a purse of $100,000, a monetary amount unheard of in this time. Unfortunately, not enough card players entered the tournament for you to draw a substantial profit. As a result, you enlisted Gambling Jack (one of the card players and an old-time buddy of yours) to help you. You agreed to let Jack cheat in the tournament if he would return the winnings to you. Since Gambling Jack always cheats (a secret only you know), you threatened to reveal his secret and ruin his card playing career if he did not comply. Gambling Jack agreed to help you, but somehow still managed to lose in the tournament. You are going to have to find a way to raise money for your cantina and fast!

As the Deadwood Poker Tournament Party approaches, you realize that it is your last chance to turn a large profit and keep your cantina from foreclosure. At the party, you plan to be the perfect host and encourage everyone to buy sarsaparillas and dance tickets from your cantina girls in order to make enough money to save your cantina!



Acting and Dressing Your Part: The owner of the cantina, you will dress with class. Assured and suave, it is vital to hide the fact that you are afraid of losing the cantina from everyone. Some may suspect you are getting in over your head financially, but you are to remain confident. You will end the night ahead. *For more ideas on how to dress and a glossary of wild western words and phrases to use at the party, please see the party tips section at www.nightofmystery.com. Simply type in murderatthedeadwoodcantina.com and explore the guest info and costuming sections on the website.*

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